

BLOCKCHAIN TECHNOLOGY To Revolutionise The GAMING INDUSTRY

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Techies in the gaming industry have always been the guinea pigs of the technology world, and right now they are teeming with the buzz around blockchain technology. It is now believed to be the world's leading software solution for digital assets

After finding its successful application in almost every field—including finance, agriculture and geospatial areas—blockchain, the decentralised technology developed by an anonymous Satoshi Nakamoto, is now making an entry into the gaming space. In fact, some believe that the gaming industry is the first to see the next generation using blockchain technology.

Journey of the gaming industry

Since ancient days games have been an eternal part of human culture for social interaction. Back then, we did not have access to technology, and games were limited to the real world. Later, with advancements in technology, the era of video games was introduced, following which we had games that could be played on PCs and mobile phones.

Earlier, these games were mostly limited to one player, or another player sitting next to us. All of this changed as game developers brought massively multiplayer online (MMO) games—games that allow several players on the same server. Now, they are trying to shift their focus towards blockchain technology.

The gaming industry today

Gaming industry is one of its kind, and is fascinating for developers as well as users and investors. However, it still has several pain points. Let us introduce you to some of these, so you know how blockchain can resolve these issues.

Fear of losing digital assets. Some of us spend a lot of time and, sometimes, money to acquire precious assets in a game. But, there is always a fear that we can lose these any day. Several scenarios can result in this outcome. The game creator might go out of business, or some central authority might ban us from playing the game. This happens all the time, as we do not own these digital valuables. Rather, these are on a centralised server.

Digital assets of one game have no value in another. Suppose, you have spent a lot of time and money to obtain a sword in one game. You complete the game, and want to move on to the next one. You cannot use this sword in the new game, as it does not belong to you (even though you spent time and money acquiring it). You cannot exchange it for something else in another game, either.

Separate servers for different regions. In an MMO role-playing game, there are separate servers for different regions. In fact, many sub-servers are required to form the whole system. So, if there are players from different regions, multiple servers are used. Also, if one server crashes, a large area loses connectivity.

Micro-transaction is a myth. Free-to-play games are based on the strategy to offer low-cost items, which are upgraded step-by-step by paying an almost negligible amount. Gradually, this small amount may add up to a large amount.

For example, a game may offer a sword for US\$ 15 and then upgrade it to the next level